

Ushasi Banerjee

✉ ushasi.banerjee@yale.edu

🌐 [ushasi-banerjee.github.io/-](https://github.com/ushasi-banerjee)

37 Hillhouse Avenue
New Haven, CT 06511, USA
Yale University

Education

2020–2026 **Ph.D in Linguistics**, Yale University, New Haven, CT
Dissertation title: *Khasi, Mizo, and a Theory of crosslinguistic variation in the nominal domain*
Advisor: Veneeta Dayal
Committee: Zoltán Gendler Szabó, Jim Wood, and Ayesha Kidwai (*external*)

2016–2018 **M.A in Linguistics**, English and Foreign Languages University, Hyderabad, India
Primary mentor: Utpal Lahiri

2013–2016 **B.A in English**, English and Foreign Languages University, Hyderabad, India

Research

AREAS Formal Semantics, Morphology, Semantics Fieldwork for under-documented languages, Typology

INTERESTS: Numeral classifiers, Number marking, Non-counting plurals, Demonstratives and Definiteness determiners, Bare nouns and Kinds

FIELDWORK: Austroasiatic: Khasi, Pnar. Tibeto-Burman: Mizo, Mongsen Ao.

Publications

Journals (TBS = To be submitted)

Under Review **Banerjee, Ushasi**. What Mizo reveals about the Architecture of D-Expressions.

TBS **Banerjee, Ushasi**. A Universal account for Numeral Classifiers: typological perspectives.

In prep **Banerjee, Ushasi**, Dee Chhange, and Bianca Nongkynrih. Bare nouns and reference in some languages of Northeast India.

Conference Proceedings

2026 **Banerjee, Ushasi**. (De)composing Reference: typological perspectives. *Semantics and Linguistic Theory (SALT)* 36. (*to appear*)

2024 **Banerjee, Ushasi**. Accounting for counting (crosslinguistically). *Semantics and Linguistic Theory (SALT)* 34: 713-733.

<https://doi.org/10.3765/c5vw5q42>

2023 Yip, Ka Fai, **Ushasi Banerjee**, and Margaret Chui Yi Lee. Are there "weak" definites in bare classifier languages?. *Semantics and Linguistic Theory (SALT)* 33: 253–275.

<https://doi.org/10.3765/56xkxm29>

2018 Meghavarshini Krishnaswamy, Indranil Dutta, and **Ushasi Banerjee**. Evidence for active cavity expansion through advanced lingual place of constriction in voiced geminates, *The Journal of Acoustical Society in America*, Vol 153, No. 1.

<https://doi.org/10.1121/1.5035741>

- 2018 **Banerjee, Ushasi**, Indranil Dutta, and Irfan. S. Coarticulatory propensity in Khalkha Mongolian, ACL Anthology, *Proceedings of 14th International Conference on Natural Language Processing*

Presentations

- 2026 (De)composing Reference: typological perspectives. *Semantics and Linguistic theory 36*, University of Buenos Aires. Poster. (*upcoming*)
- 2024 Accounting for counting (crosslinguistically). *Semantics and Linguistic theory 34*, University of Rochester. Talk.
- 2023 Are there "weak" definites in bare classifier languages?. *Semantics and Linguistic theory 33*, Yale University. Talk. (with Ka Fai Yip and Margaret Chui Yi Lee)
- 2023 Khasi as a Classifier language. *(In)definiteness and genericity across languages SALT 33 satellite sessions*, Yale University. Poster.
- 2022 Some question particles in Bangla and where to find them. *Language Diversity, Linguistic Theory and Cultural Identity in South Asia (LDSA)*, Yale University. Poster.
- 2019 Modals in Bangla: Interaction with Tense and Aspect. *Creteling Poster Sessions, University of Crete, Greece*. Poster.
- 2018 Coarticulatory Propensity in Khalkha Mongolian. *International Conference on Natural Language Processing (ICON), India*. Poster. (with Indranil Dutta)

Fellowships and Awards

- 2020-2026 Yale Graduate School of Arts and Sciences Fellowship (tuition and stipend)
- 2026 MacMillan Center International Conference Travel Grant, Yale University
- 2024 MacMillan Center International Dissertation Research Fellowship, Yale University
- 2023 Linguistic Society of America Summer Program Award, Yale University
- 2019 CreteLing Summer School Fellowship, Creteling Organizers
- 2018 Junior Research Fellowship (UGC-NET JRF), University Grants Commission India

Teaching

- Spring 2026 Teaching Fellow for *Phonology I*, Instructor: Natalie Weber, Yale University
- Fall 2025 Teaching Fellow for *Semantics I*, Instructor: Simon Charlow, Yale University
- Spring 2024 Teaching Fellow for *Pragmatics*, Instructor: Laurence Horn, Yale University
- Fall 2023 Teaching Fellow for *Introduction to Linguistics*, Instructor: Jim Wood, Yale University
- Spring 2023 Teaching Fellow for *Cognitive Science of Language*, Instructor: Robert Frank, Yale University
- Fall 2022 Teaching Fellow for *Semantics I*, Instructor: Veneeta Dayal, Yale University
- Fall 2019 Teaching Fellow for *Introduction to Formal Semantics*, Instructor: Utpal Lahiri, English and Foreign Languages University

Other research and study experience

Research

- 2025 (online) Fieldwork, Project: Deictic definites and demonstratives in Mizo
- 2025, 2024 (on-site) Fieldwork in Meghalaya, Project: Classifiers and plural marking in Khasi
- 2024 (on-site) Fieldwork in Mizoram, Project: Bare nouns and (in)definiteness in Mizo
- 2017 Building an automatic speech detection system for Naga languages, Indian Institute of Technology, Guwahati. Supervisor: Shakuntala Mahanta

Study

- 2023 LSA Linguistic Institute, Linguistic Society of America, University of Massachusetts, Amherst.
- 2019 Creteling Summer School, University of Greece, Rethymnon
- 2017 QIP-CEP Workshop on Experimental & Empirical Methods in Linguistics, Indian Institute of Technology, New Delhi.

Academic Service

- 2026 Reviewer, Semantics of Natural Languages
- 2024 Reviewer, NELS abstracts
- 2022 Co-Organizer, SNEWS at Yale University
- 2022 Website designer: Language Diversity, Linguistic Theory and Cultural Identity in South Asia (LDSA) at Yale University
- 2021–2022 Organizer, Semantics Reading Group at Yale

Skills

Languages	<i>Native/near-native</i>	<i>Fieldwork/research</i>	<i>Coursework</i>
	Bangla	Khasi	ASL
	English	Mizo	Spanish
	Hindi	Mongsen Ao	
		Yoruba	
		Khalkha Mongolian	
Computing	L ^A T _E X, Python, R, Ruby		

References

Veneeta Dayal

Dorothy R. Diebold Professor of Linguistics & Chair
Department of Linguistics, Yale University
37 Hillhouse (rm. 314)
New Haven, CT 06511, U.S.A.
veneeta.dayal@yale.edu

Jim Wood

Associate Professor & Director of Graduate Studies
Department of Linguistics, Yale University
37 Hillhouse
New Haven, CT 06511, U.S.A.
jimwood8@gmail.com

Zoltán Szabó

John S. Saden Professor of Philosophy and Linguistics
Department of Philosophy, Yale University
451 College Street
New Haven, CT 06511-6629, U.S.A.
zoltan.szabo@yale.edu